

Musical Terminology

words used to describe music/sound/noise

- Sound/Timbre
 - Instruments/Instrumentation
 - Strings (Chordophones): Violin, Cello, Guitar, Piano, etc
 - Winds (Aerophones): Brass, Flutes, Reeds (Double, Single), Organ
 - Percussion: Membrane (Membranophones), Solid Substance (Idiophones)
 - Voice: Sung, Spoken, Whispered, Yelled/Screamed
 - Electronic: Synthesizer, Drum Machine, Theramine, etc
 - Dynamics
 - Loud vs Soft
 - Consistent vs Variable
 - Articulation: Short (Staccato) vs Long (Legato)
 - Tone quality
- Pitch
 - High vs Low
 - Fixed vs Bent
 - Tonic/Dominant vs No Pitch Center
 - Scales: Diatonic vs Gap
 - Melody vs Harmony
- Rhythm
 - Beat: Free vs Pulsed
 - Tempo: Constant vs Variable
 - Meter
 - Constant vs Variable
 - Simple vs Compound
 - Polyrhythm
- Texture
 - Monophony, Polyphony, vs Homophony
- Form
 - One idea vs Multiple ideas
 - Repetition, Variation, vs Development
- Repertoire
 - Classical vs Popular vs Folk
- Genre
 - Symphony, Chamber, Sonata, Concerto, etc

Periods of Music

	Medieval / Renaissance	Baroque	Classical	Romantic	Modern
Instruments	Limited Diverse Experimental	Limited Diverse Experimental	Limited Diverse Experimental	Limited Diverse Experimental	Limited Diverse Experimental
Dynamics	Mostly Constant Some Contrast Dramatic Contrast	Mostly Constant Some Contrast Dramatic Contrast	Mostly Constant Some Contrast Dramatic Contrast	Mostly Constant Some Contrast Dramatic Contrast	Mostly Constant Some Contrast Dramatic Contrast
Melody	Simple Ornamented Expansive	Simple Ornamented Expansive	Simple Ornamented Expansive	Simple Ornamented Expansive	Simple Ornamented Expansive
Harmony	Modal Tonal Atonal	Modal Tonal Atonal	Modal Tonal Atonal	Modal Tonal Atonal	Modal Tonal Atonal
Rhythm	Flexible Steady Complex	Flexible Steady Complex	Flexible Steady Complex	Flexible Steady Complex	Flexible Steady Complex
Texture	Monophony Homophony Polyphony	Monophony Homophony Polyphony	Monophony Homophony Polyphony	Monophony Homophony Polyphony	Monophony Homophony Polyphony
Form	One idea Multiple ideas	One idea Multiple ideas	One idea Multiple ideas	One idea Multiple ideas	One idea Multiple ideas
Genre	Sacred Opera Symphony Chamber Concerto	Sacred Opera Symphony Chamber Concerto	Sacred Opera Symphony Chamber Concerto	Sacred Opera Symphony Chamber Concerto	Sacred Opera Symphony Chamber Concerto
Notable Events	Printing Press Heliocentrism Scientific Method Democracy Industrial Revolution World War II Digital Age	Printing Press Heliocentrism Scientific Method Democracy Industrial Revolution World War II Digital Age	Printing Press Heliocentrism Scientific Method Democracy Industrial Revolution World War II Digital Age	Printing Press Heliocentrism Scientific Method Democracy Industrial Revolution World War II Digital Age	Printing Press Heliocentrism Scientific Method Democracy Industrial Revolution World War II Digital Age